Name: **Group:** **Date:**

4 ESO · SEASONS & CELEBRATIONS · ROUTE PLUS

Learning Path 4 · Research it right

✏️ Paper worksheet: do the same activities as on the computer. Write your answers and circle the letter of the right option. Do it without notes the first time.

🎯 My goal

Before you start: think about your last recall or checkpoint. What do you want to get better at in this Learning Path?

1 Recall: Learning Paths 2 and 3

Type the answers without looking.

1. 25 December = the twenty-_____ of December
2. I like it _____ we eat together.
3. _____, we clean the house. Then we decorate it.
4. Hanukkah _____ (last) eight nights.
5. We visit relatives _____ Christmas.
6. Children get red _____ with money at Lunar New Year.
7. People in Ireland _____ _____ carve turnips.
8. Halloween is about costumes, _____ the Castanyada is about family.
9. Diwali, _____ is celebrated in autumn, is the festival of lights.
10. _____ it started in Europe, Halloween is popular in the USA.

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2 Reading: Check it before you share it

This text explains how to know if a source is reliable. Read it and answer.

Before any information goes on your slides, it should be checked. Good researchers ask four questions.

1. Who wrote it? Look for an author or an organisation whose job is to inform, such as a museum, a university, an encyclopedia or an official tourism website. If no author or organisation is given, be careful: anyone can publish online.

2. When was it written or updated? The dates of festivals that follow the moon, such as Diwali, Hanukkah and Lunar New Year, change every year, so information that was correct last year may be wrong now. Check that it has been updated for this year.

3. Why was it written? Some pages are written to inform; others are written to sell costumes or trips, or simply to get as many views as possible. A shop may describe a tradition as “ancient” because it sounds good and helps it sell, even if the tradition only dates back a few decades.

4. Do other sources say the same? Never rely on a single source. Each fact should be confirmed by at least two reliable sources. If they disagree, choose the more reliable one, or say clearly that the sources disagree.

Be careful with your wording, too. A religious celebration should be presented as information, not as belief: “Hindus believe that…”, “For many Jewish families, the candles mean…”. Avoid stereotypes and generalisations such as “all Chinese people…”, and remember that a sacred symbol is not a costume.

Finally, credit your sources: the title of the page, the website or author, and the year. Images need credits too. Never copy whole sentences: take notes with key words and then write your own sentences.

1. What should you look for first?
   a) how many pictures it has **b)** who wrote it **c)** how long it is
2. Why must you check the date of Diwali or Hanukkah?
   a) It changes every year. **b)** Nobody knows it. **c)** It is always the same.
3. How many sources do you need for each fact?
   a) at least two **b)** one **c)** five
4. Why might a shop say a tradition is “ancient”?
   a) because shops are experts **b)** because it sounds good and helps it sell **c)** because it is always true
5. What should you do if two reliable sources disagree?
   a) choose the more reliable one or say that they disagree **b)** use the first one you found
   c) invent the answer
6. Which sentence avoids a stereotype?
   a) Chinese people always wear red. **b)** Many families in China celebrate with a reunion dinner.
   c) All Chinese people eat dumplings at New Year.

3 Reliable, check it, or not reliable?

Choose for each source. Read the explanation after you check.

1. A page about Diwali on a national museum’s website, author named, updated 2025.
   a) Reliable **b)** Check it **c)** Not reliable
2. A costume shop blog: “The ancient history of Halloween costumes, 20 % off this week!”
   a) Reliable **b)** Not reliable **c)** Check it

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3. A 15-second social video, “Lunar New Year facts you didn’t know 🤯”, no sources.
   a) Not reliable **b)** Check it **c)** Reliable
4. An online encyclopedia article on Thanksgiving with references.
   a) Check it **b)** Reliable **c)** Not reliable
5. An anonymous forum answer from 2011: “Hanukkah is always on 25 December.”
   a) Reliable **b)** Check it **c)** Not reliable
6. The Catalan government’s culture website on the Castanyada.
   a) Not reliable **b)** Reliable **c)** Check it

4 Information, not belief

Choose the version that presents the celebration as information, respectfully.

1. “During Diwali, light wins over darkness.”
   a) Diwali is when darkness disappears. **b)** Diwali makes light win over darkness.
   c) For many Hindus, Diwali celebrates light winning over darkness.
2. “The candles of Hanukkah are a miracle.”
   a) Hanukkah candles are a miracle every year.
   b) For Jewish families, the candles remember a story about a miracle.
   c) The candles of Hanukkah are magic.
3. “Halloween is a weird American party.”
   a) Halloween is a strange party.
   b) Halloween is very popular in the USA, and it comes from an old Celtic festival.
   c) Halloween is only for Americans.
4. “People in China all eat dumplings.”
   a) Chinese people only eat dumplings.
   b) Many families in northern China eat dumplings at Lunar New Year.
   c) All Chinese people eat dumplings.

5 Notes, not copies

Choose the best notes: key words, not copied sentences.

1. “Lunar New Year is celebrated in China, Vietnam and Korea in late January or February.”
   a) LNY: China · summer **b)** LNY: China, Vietnam, Korea · late Jan / Feb
   c) Lunar New Year is celebrated in China, Vietnam and Korea in late January or February.
2. “Families light one more candle on the menorah every night, for eight nights.”
   a) Families light one more candle on the menorah every night. **b)** Hanukkah: 1 candle · 1 night
   c) Hanukkah: menorah · +1 candle a night · 8 nights
3. “The first Thanksgiving was a three-day harvest feast in 1621.”
   a) Thanksgiving: 1863 · 1 day **b)** 1st Thanksgiving: 1621 · harvest feast · 3 days
   c) The first Thanksgiving was a three-day harvest feast in 1621.

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6 Credit your sources

*Order: **"Title of the page", website or author, year.** Example: "The Castanyada", Catalan culture website, 2025.*

1. Which credit line is in the right order?
   a) Encyclopedia website 2024 "Diwali" **b)** "Diwali", Encyclopedia website, 2024.
   c) 2024, Diwali, Encyclopedia website.
2. Which credit line is complete?
   a) I found it on the internet. **b)** "Thanksgiving history".
   c) "Thanksgiving history", History museum website, 2025.

7 Listen: a podcast is a source too

Listen to the LP3 podcast like a researcher: what facts does it give, which ones would you check, and how does it talk about beliefs?

🎧 **Culture Bites: the story behind two autumn celebrations** · If you cannot listen to it, read transcript 1 at the end of the worksheet (twice, as if you were listening).

1. What kind of source is Culture Bites?
   a) a newspaper **b)** a podcast **c)** an encyclopedia
2. Which of these is a fact you can check?
   a) Pumpkins are more fun than turnips. **b)** Thanksgiving is the best celebration.
   c) Thanksgiving became a national holiday in 1863.
3. How long did the 1621 harvest feast last?
   a) one day **b)** three days **c)** a week
4. Who made Thanksgiving a national holiday?
   a) the Wampanoag people **b)** the Pilgrims **c)** President Abraham Lincoln
5. For some Native Americans, Thanksgiving is…
   a) a harvest festival **b)** a day of shopping **c)** a day of mourning
6. What did people use to carve before pumpkins?
   a) apples **b)** potatoes **c)** turnips
7. How does Emma talk about the Thanksgiving story?
   a) She says only one version is true. **b)** She says the story is not important.
   c) She says not everybody sees it in the same way.
8. You want to write “Samhain took place more than two thousand years ago” on your card. What should you do?
   a) Copy it: a podcast is always right. **b)** Leave it out: old facts can’t be checked.
   c) Check it in a second reliable source.
9. Which words show that the speaker is reporting a belief, not a fact?
   a) “people believed that…” **b)** “It lasted three days.” **c)** “It took place in Ireland…”
10. What would you need to credit this podcast on your card?
    a) only the speakers’ first names **b)** its name, the episode and the date you listened
    c) nothing: audio sources don’t need credits

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8 Shadowing · Culture Bites: the story behind two autumn celebrations

Repeat part of the listening just behind the speaker, like a shadow.

How it works

Your teacher plays the clip three times: first read while you listen, then mumble the words along, then say them aloud just behind the speaker.

Emma: Welcome back to Culture Bites. Today: where do two famous autumn celebrations come from? Let's start with Halloween.

Sam: Halloween comes from an old Celtic festival called Samhain. It took place in Ireland and Scotland more than two thousand years ago, at the end of the harvest and the start of winter.

Emma: And people believed that on that night, the spirits of the dead came back.

Sam: Exactly. So people used to light bonfires and wear masks to hide from the spirits. And here's a surprise: they didn't use pumpkins. They used to carve turnips!

9 Talk: can we trust it?

A teammate asks you about the source you found for your research card.

Your task

Answer about your real source with reasons and evidence, and explain what you do when two sources disagree.

1. **Where did you find your information?**

2. **Who wrote it?**

3. **Is it reliable? Why?**

4. **When was it written?**

5. **Did you check the facts in a second source?**

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6. **How do you write about people's beliefs with respect?**

7. **What do you do if two sources say different things?**

Then · Have the conversation aloud with a classmate: they ask and you answer, then swap.

Model
I found it on Britannica, an online encyclopedia. It was written by a historian and updated in 2024, so it's recent and the author is an expert. I checked the main date on a museum website and they agreed. When I write about beliefs, I use phrases like "for many Hindus" or "people believe", so I don't present a belief as a fact. If two sources disagree, I look for a third, more official one, and if they still disagree, I write "some sources say…" and give both.

10 Piece 3: research card

*Fill it in with your group and hand it in individually. Short notes with key words. You need **three sources**.*

Is it reliable? Ask four questions about each source: who wrote it, when, why (to inform, to sell, to entertain) and where it is published.
Model: *Reliable: a national museum wrote it to inform, and it was updated in 2025. · Check it: a shop wrote it to sell costumes, and there is no author.*

Stereotype: *Some people think ___. This is unfair because ___. On our day, we will ___.*

Celebration: what, when and where
e.g. Diwali · festival of lights · Oct / Nov · India and worldwide

Three customs

One food or symbol

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Origin (one fact)

Comparison with a local celebration

How it has changed · how to present it inclusively

Source 1: credit line
"Title", website or author, year.

Source 1: key information (notes)

Source 1: reliable or not? Two reasons

Source 2: credit line
"Title", website or author, year.

Source 2: key information (notes)

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Source 2: reliable or not? Two reasons

Source 3: credit line

"Title", website or author, year.

Source 3: key information (notes)

Source 3: reliable or not? Two reasons

Where do your sources agree, and where do they differ? (one point at least)

Which source do you trust most, and why?

One stereotype about the people who celebrate it: why it is unfair, and how your group will avoid it

Self-assessment

Circle: 1 Not yet · 2 Partly · 3 Mostly · 4 Fully

Every fact is in two sources, and I say which source wins when they disagree	**1 · 2 · 3 · 4**
Notes, not copied sentences	**1 · 2 · 3 · 4**

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Two precise reasons for each source (author, date, purpose, channel)	**1 · 2 · 3 · 4**
Religious meanings as information	**1 · 2 · 3 · 4**
I explain why the stereotype is unfair and how our plan avoids it	**1 · 2 · 3 · 4**

🔁 **How did it go?**

What helped me most?

What do I need to review?

📚 Study guide: prepare for Checkpoint 3 and the final exam

How to study what you learn in this Learning Path, and practice that works like the checkpoint and looks like the exam. The answer key is at the end of each activity.

How to study

🧠 **Test yourself, don't reread**

Close your notes and try to remember: write the words, say the rule, answer the questions. Then check. Rereading and highlighting feel useful, but you remember much less.

Retrieval practice · Roediger & Karpicke 2006; Dunlosky et al. 2013

📅 **Spread it out**

Three short sessions of 15 minutes on different days work better than one long session the day before.

Spacing · Cepeda et al. 2006

🔀 **Mix it up**

Practise similar things together so you learn to choose the right one for each sentence.

Interleaving · Rohrer & Taylor 2007

✅ **Check and fix at once**

Mark your answers with the key straight away and write each wrong answer again, correctly.

Feedback · Hattie & Timperley 2007

💬 **Say why**

For every answer, say the reason: "on, because it's a date." Explaining makes the rule stick.

Self-explanation · Dunlosky et al. 2013

😴 **Sleep on it**

Your brain stores what you learn while you sleep. A short self-test and a good night's sleep beat studying late the night before.

Sleep and memory · Diekelmann & Born 2010

My plan

1. **Today** · Close this page and write from memory: three things to check in a source and five words from Learning Paths 1–3. Then check.
2. **In 2–3 days** · Do "Practise for Checkpoint 3" below. Look at the key and write again what you got wrong.
3. **Before Checkpoint 3** · Go over the flashcards: only the ones you still miss.
4. **The week before the exam** · Do the exam-style practice in every Learning Path, then the Sample exam. Repeat only the parts you failed.

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What comes up

Checkpoint 3 (LS1, Learning Paths 1–3 and 5): short gaps, one question at a time, about 45 seconds each, no going back and no notes. You do it once, and you must stay on the page: if you leave it, it is sent. It opens the next Learning Path.
Final exam: what you learn here helps in the Reading (taking notes, like the reading log). Use this Learning Path to review the vocabulary and grammar of Learning Paths 1–3.

Practise for Checkpoint 3

One question at a time · 45 s

It works like the real checkpoint: 13 questions, one at a time, about 45 seconds each, with no going back and no notes. This is only practice: nothing is sent, you can repeat it, and at the end you see your answers and the key.

On paper: cover the questions and uncover them one at a time, about 45 seconds each, with no going back.

1. The days get _____ in summer.
2. Hanukkah is a festival of eight _____.
3. We visit our grandparents _____ Sunday.
4. Families eat turkey at _____ in the USA.
5. My friends _____ (play) football after school.
6. At Lunar New Year, children get red envelopes with _____.
7. I feel _____ when I watch a horror film.
8. We have a special _____ with all the family at Christmas.
9. The festival _____ _____ every year in March.
10. Lunar New Year is _____ to Christmas: families get together.
11. Did people in Ireland _____ to carve turnips?
12. Candles _____ _____ (light) every night at Hanukkah.
13. Many traditions _____ when families move to a new country.

Like the exam: Reading

4 × 2 points

Read the text and choose the right answer.

Sant Jordi

Every year on 23 April, Catalonia celebrates Sant Jordi, a day of books and roses. Traditionally, people give a rose or a book to someone they love, although today many people give both. The streets of Barcelona fill with stalls, and queues form in front of famous writers who sign their books.

According to the legend, Sant Jordi killed a dragon, and a red rose grew from its blood. The day became even more international in 1995, when UNESCO chose 23 April as World Book Day, the date when both Cervantes and Shakespeare died.

1. What do people give on Sant Jordi? [2 points]

a) a rose or a book **b)** chocolate eggs **c)** money **d)** a present for children only

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2. Where does the legend say the rose came from? [2 points]

a) the dragon's blood **b)** a writer's book **c)** the king's castle **d)** a garden in Barcelona

3. Which is the correct note about Sant Jordi? [2 points]

a) What: books and roses · When: 23 April · Where: the UK

b) What: books and roses · When: 23 April · Where: Catalonia

c) What: dragons and fireworks · When: 23 April · Where: Catalonia

d) What: books and roses · When: 24 April · Where: Catalonia

4. You want to check when UNESCO made it World Book Day. Which source is best? [2 points]

a) a bookshop advert **b)** a forum answer from 2010 **c)** UNESCO's official website

d) a 10-second video with no author

Like the exam: Vocabulary

1 point · gaps 2 points

Choose the right word, or type it.

1. At Diwali, people give each other ___. [1 point]

a) presents **b)** parades **c)** turnips **d)** costumes

2. In ___, it is hot and sunny. [1 point]

a) autumn **b)** summer **c)** harvest **d)** winter

3. We ___ the Christmas tree with lights. [1 point]

a) visit **b)** celebrate **c)** decorate **d)** dress

4. Children dress ___ as witches at Halloween. [1 point]

a) up **b)** out **c)** on **d)** in

5. Everybody takes _____ in the school parade. [2 points]

6. Some people say Christmas is all about c_____: buying more and more. [2 points]

Like the exam: Grammar

1 point · gaps 2 points

Choose the right form, or type it.

1. Lunar New Year ___ in late January or February. [1 point]

a) are **b)** am **c)** is **d)** be

2. My mum ___ the house before the party. [1 point]

a) cleans **b)** cleaning **c)** are clean **d)** clean

3. We eat twelve grapes ___ midnight on New Year's Eve. [1 point]

a) at **b)** in **c)** to **d)** on

4. Diwali _____ (last) five days. [2 points]

5. Many years ago, people _____ _____ make panellets at home. Now they buy them. [2 points]

6. Abraham Lincoln, _____ made Thanksgiving official, was president in 1863. [2 points]

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📚 Study guide: answer key

Look at them only when you have finished each activity.

Practise for Checkpoint 3

1. **longer** · Summer: the days get longer.
2. **nights** · eight nights = vuit nits.
3. **on** · Days → on.
4. **thanksgiving** · Thanksgiving: turkey.
5. **play** · They: no -s.
6. **money** · Red envelopes with money.
7. **scared** · scared = afraid.
8. **meal** · a special meal = a big family lunch or dinner.
9. **takes place** · take place / be held = happen.
10. **similar** · similar to = almost the same as.
11. **use** · Questions: Did… use to…? (no -d).
12. **are lit** · Passive: are + past participle (light → lit).
13. **evolve** · evolve / adapt = change little by little.

Like the exam: Reading

1. **a rose or a book** · "…a rose or a book to someone they love."
2. **the dragon's blood** · "…a red rose grew from its blood."
3. **What: books and roses · When: 23 April · Where: Catalonia** · Check all three parts: what, when and where.
4. **UNESCO's official website** · An official website is the most reliable.

Like the exam: Vocabulary

1. **presents** · presents = gifts.
2. **summer** · summer = estiu.
3. **decorate** · decorate = make it look nice.
4. **up** · dress up = wear a costume.
5. **part** · take part in = join.
6. **consumerism** · consumerism = buying too much.

Like the exam: Grammar

1. **is** · It → is.
2. **cleans** · She → cleans.
3. **at** · Time → at.
4. **lasts** · It → lasts.
5. **used to** · A past habit that is not true now.

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6. **who** · Non-defining relative for people: who.

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Transcripts (only if you cannot listen)

Transcript 1 · Culture Bites: the story behind two autumn celebrations

Emma: Welcome back to Culture Bites. Today: where do two famous autumn celebrations come from? Let’s start with Halloween.

Sam: Halloween comes from an old Celtic festival called Samhain. It took place in Ireland and Scotland more than two thousand years ago, at the end of the harvest and the start of winter.

Emma: And people believed that on that night, the spirits of the dead came back.

Sam: Exactly. So people used to light bonfires and wear masks to hide from the spirits. And here’s a surprise: they didn’t use pumpkins. They used to carve turnips!

Emma: Turnips? So where do the pumpkins come from?

Sam: In the 1800s, many Irish people moved to the United States. Pumpkins were bigger and easier to carve, so the tradition changed.

Emma: Now, Thanksgiving. It takes place on the fourth Thursday of November, and this year that’s the twenty-sixth.

Sam: The story usually starts in 1621. A group of English settlers, the Pilgrims, had a harvest feast with the Wampanoag people, who lived in the area. It lasted three days.

Emma: But it didn’t become a national holiday until 1863, when President Abraham Lincoln made it official.

Sam: Today families travel home, get together and share a big meal, usually with turkey. Many people say what they are grateful for.

Emma: It’s important to remember that not everybody sees the story in the same way. For some Native Americans, it is a day of mourning, a day to remember what they lost.

Sam: So both celebrations started as harvest festivals, but they have changed a lot over time.

Emma: That’s all for today. Happy holidays!

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